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Long stretches of pure white sand, beautifully carved glaciers nestled between snow-capped mountains, plush green valleys replete with colours and fauna, rugged terrain punctuated by dangerous gorges—it's high time you stop picturing these beautiful images as mere wallpapers. It's time for a vacation—you deserve a break.

With the festive season just round the corner, a rollicking holiday season due, and travel sounds a really exciting way to relish that elusive break. But there's a catch, though. You have a crammed schedule that leaves you with little time to chase tour operators and holiday packages. Is there a way out? The good news is that there is not one, but many.

Look to the Internet—travel Web sites are willing to do all the planning. From honeymooners to adventurers, from short vacations to designer holidays, sites have vacation packages. Says Sachin Bhatia, Chief Marketing Officer, Makemytrip India Pvt Ltd, "Online travel transactions account for over 33 per cent of all e-commerce across the world." Travelling has assumed a whole new dimension with the growing popularity of online purchase and auction of tickets. While Indian Railways offers online booking, Sahara and Indiatimes came up with round-the-clock bidding on tickets.

A Few Good Sites

Take the case of Priya B, a Pune-based software professional who planned her honeymoon trip to the Andaman and Nicobar Islands. With her fiancé away in

London, she thought it would be a daunting task going about all the arrangements. Until she stumbled upon www.traveljini.com. It turned out to be the one-stop guide with all the details that she was hunting for. Interestingly, travel Web sites go beyond the routine, mundane details that tour operators would otherwise provide. In fact, the sites take you on a virtual tour, making the destinations come alive with vivid descriptions.

Bhatia says that a Web site is the preferred medium of information for Indians when it comes to travelling abroad. Be it www.outlooktraveller.com or www.traveljini.com, sites offer information on everything, from a restaurant in Athens serving vegetarian food, to what an Indian would fancy while shopping in Malaysia. If you are



Calling All Mouse Potatoes! Bon Voyage

The holiday season is round the corner. From now on, you don't need to go through the hassles of arranging your entire tour—let Web sites do it for you

